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LDCE IP / PS Gr. B · STUDY NOTES

SCHEDULE OF FINANCIAL POWERS

of

Divisional Heads

&

Heads of Circles / Heads of Department

Statutory Basis & Currency

Delegation of Financial Powers Rules (DFPR), 2024 · Rule 12(2)

Base OM No. 6-1/2021-Fin.Coord dated 28.03.2025 (effective 01.04.2025)

Updated as per Addendum III — F.No.6-2/2025-FA(P) dated 09.06.2026 (latest)

⚠ DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and the inclusion of recent changes, amendments, and updates to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations — including the base OM dated 28.03.2025 and Addendums I (22.05.2025), II (08.09.2025) and III (09.06.2026) — this document is intended as a study aid only. Readers and students are strongly recommended to refer to official Government sources or gazettes for the most reliable and authoritative information.

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What's New — Addendum III (09.06.2026)

This edition is updated to the LATEST position after Addendum III [F.No.6-2/2025-FA(P) dated 09.06.2026], and also incorporates the earlier Addendums I (22.05.2025) and II (08.09.2025). Wherever a later Addendum re-states an item, that version is the current in-force figure. Amended entries carry an amber flag; freshly inserted entries carry a green flag throughout the booklet.

Schedule II-A (HOC & HOD) — Key Addendum III Changes

Item	What Changed by Addendum III
Note 1 (HOD)	“Director Postal Services (HQ)” added to the Head of Department definition
SL.1(ii)	Ad-hoc arrears of pay — headline extent raised to Up to Rs.5,00,000/-
SL.4(i)	Cash Award to Postal Employees — Rs.10,000 → Rs.25,000
SL.4(ii)	Cash Award to GDS — Rs.2,000 → Rs.25,000
SL.4(iii)/(iv)	Rewards to non-Govt persons — Rs.1,000 → Rs.10,000 (each)
OH-06 SL.4(a) NEW	Medical Treatment — Reimbursement of Medical bills: Up to Rs.10 Lakh/case (IFA >Rs.1 L)
SL.10(i)	Recurring contingent — HOC Rs.5 L/case (cap Rs.50 L p.a.); HOD Rs.3 L/case (cap Rs.30 L p.a.)
SL.10(ii)	Non-recurring contingent — HOC Rs.5 L/case (cap Rs.50 L p.a.); HOD Rs.3 L/case (cap Rs.30 L p.a.)
SL.10(iv)	Petty stationery — HOC Rs.15 L p.a.; HOD Rs.10 L p.a.; + Secretary(PSB) Rs.10 L/case (cap Rs.40 L p.a.)
SL.10(x)	Auction commission — HOC Rs.2 L; HOD Rs.1 L on any occasion
SL.10(xvii)	Foundation Stone / Inauguration — Rs.5 L → Rs.10 L per occasion
SL.12(i)(c)	Printing ‘Others’ — Rs.1.5 L → Rs.5 L per annum
SL.17(i)/(ii)	Advertising — BoC/DAVP Rs.5 L → Rs.10 L; other media Rs.2 L → Rs.5 L per case
SL.19(ii)	Market survey / consultants — delegates now CGM(BD/PD/PLI) AND HOC
SL.25(i)	Operational vehicle — now “HOC & Director (RAKNPA) only”
SL.27(v)	Laptops for office use — HOC Rs.5 L → Rs.50 L p.a.; + HOD Rs.25 L p.a.
SL.28(i)	Construction/reconstruction — HOC Rs.10 Cr → Rs.20 Cr; + HOD Rs.10 Cr

Item	What Changed by Addendum III
SL.28(ii)	Addition/alteration (non-res.) — Rs.2 Cr → HOC&HOD Rs.5 Cr; + heritage Rs.20 Cr (HOC only)
SL.35(iii)	Conveyance by Road/RTN — HOC Rs.10 Cr → Rs.20 Cr; + HOD Rs.1 Cr per contract
SL.35(iv)/(v)	By other means Rs.2.5 L → Rs.5 L/month; foreign steamer Rs.5 L → Rs.10 L
SL.37	Negotiated/Single tender — HOC Rs.50 L; + HOD Rs.10 L per case

Schedule III (Divisional Heads etc.) — Addendum III Changes

Item	What Changed by Addendum III
OH-06 SL.3(a) NEW	Medical Treatment — Reimbursement of Medical bills: Up to Rs.2 Lakh/case
SL.8(i)	Contingent (non-recurring) — Rs.10,000 → Rs.25,000/case (cap Rs.3 L p.a.)
SL.8(iv)	Fixtures & furniture — Rs.2 L p.a. → Rs.1 L/case (cap Rs.10 L p.a.)
SL.8(v)	Customer meets — Rs.10,000 → Rs.25,000/meet; + Working Lunch Rs.500/head; cap Rs.1 L p.a.
SL.8(vi)	Office equipment — Rs.5,000 → Rs.50,000/case (cap Rs.5 L p.a.)
SL.8(viii)	Emergent stock/stationery — Rs.50,000 → Rs.2 Lakh p.a.
SL.8(ix)	Carriage of mails (non rail/air) — Rs.10,000/month → Rs.50,000/case (cap Rs.6 L p.a.)
SL.9(ii)	Hiring for exam/customer meet — Rs.5,000 → Rs.10,000/case
SL.12(i)	Minor Civil — Govt Buildings — Rs.50,000 → Rs.1 L/case (cap Rs.5 L p.a.)
SL.12(ii)	Minor Civil — Rented Building — Rs.5,000 → Rs.30,000 (non-scheme) / Rs.50,000 (scheme)
SL.12(iii)	Removable fittings (Rented) — Rs.5,000 → Rs.30,000/case (cap Rs.3 L p.a.)
SL.18 (OH-29)	Repair & Maintenance — Rs.10,000 → Rs.25,000/case
SL.14(f) NEW	Refund — Compensation of loss/damage/non-delivery: Full powers
Foreign Post Office NEW	New sub-section — SL.19 Refund (a),(b),(c): Full powers

◆ Note on Currency

Addendum III (09.06.2026) is the LATEST amendment. Where it re-states an item, its figure is the current in-force position and supersedes the base OM (28.03.2025) and Addendums I & II for that item.

Items unchanged by Addendum III retain their value from the base OM as modified by Addendums I / II.

Schedule II-B (Independent Directors) and Schedule II-C (Sr. DDG-PAF / GM(F) / DsAP) are OUTSIDE this syllabus and are not reproduced here.

The closing para of Addendum III records approval of Secretary (Posts) in consultation with JS&FA under Rule 12(2), DFPR 2024.



Contents

1.	Delegation of Financial Powers — Background & Effective Date
2.	Key Definitions & Coverage of Officers
3.	Conditions Governing Exercise of Powers
4.	Schedule II — General Notes 1 to 5
5.	Schedule II-A — Powers of HOC & HOD (Object Heads)
6.	Other Financial Powers of HOC / HOD (Conveyance, Refunds, Negotiated Tender)
7.	Schedule III — Powers of Divisional Heads & Others (Object Heads)
8.	Other Financial Powers of Divisional Heads (Refunds)
9.	Master Comparison: HOC vs HOD vs Divisional Head
10.	Quick-Revision Mnemonics & Memory Hooks



1. Delegation of Financial Powers

Background & Legislative Journey

Originally, the financial powers of the Department of Posts officers were exercised based on the common **Schedule of Financial Powers** of the erstwhile *Posts & Telegraphs Department*. This continued till the historic bifurcation.

Milestone Date	Event	Significance
January 1985	Bifurcation of P&T into DoP and DoT	Department of Posts came into independent existence.
01.04.1988	DoP brought under DFPR, 1978	Separate Schedule of Financial Powers drawn up for DoP.
30.07.2021	OM No. 6-1/2021-Fin.Coord	Last revision under the DFPR, 1978 regime.
01.04.2024	DFPR 2024 came into force	MoF replaced DFPR, 1978 with DFPR 2024 — old schedules lost relevance.
28.03.2025	Revised Schedules II-A, II-B, II-C & III notified	Current delegation under Rule 12(2) DFPR 2024; effective 01.04.2025.
22.05.2025	Addendum I	First set of modifications to the 28.03.2025 schedules.
08.09.2025	Addendum II	Second set of revisions (HOD outsourcing, new OHs in Sch. III etc.).
09.06.2026	Addendum III	Latest revisions — incorporated in this booklet.

◆ CRUCIAL EXAM POINTERS — Dates to Remember

- DFPR 2024 commenced: 01st April, 2024
- Revised DoP Schedules notified: 28.03.2025 (effective 01.04.2025)
- Addendum I: 22.05.2025 · II: 08.09.2025 · III: 09.06.2026 (latest)
- Authority for delegation: Rule 12(2) of DFPR, 2024
- Approving authority: Secretary (Posts) in consultation with AS&FA

Four Schedules under DFPR 2024 (DoP)

Schedule	Delegated To	Status for our syllabus
Schedule II-A	Heads of Circle (HOC) & Heads of Department (HOD)	✓ COVERED in this booklet
Schedule II-B	Directors (Postal Services) having Independent Charge	✗ Out of syllabus
Schedule II-C	Sr. DDG (PAF), GM (Finance) & Directors of Accounts (Postal)	✗ Out of syllabus
Schedule III	Heads of Postal Divisions, RMS Divisions, Chief PM (GPO), Supdt. PSDs, Sr. PM	✓ COVERED in this booklet

2. Key Definitions & Coverage of Officers

Note 1 — Who is a “Head of Department” (HOD)?

For the purpose of the Schedule, “Head of Department” includes the following officers:

- ▶ Secretary, Postal Services Board (PSB)
- ▶ Chief Post Masters General (CPMG)
- ▶ Chief General Managers (CGMs)
- ▶ Director, Rafi Ahmed Kidwai National Postal Academy (RAKNPA)
- ▶ Post Masters General (PMG)
- ▶ Sr. DDG (PAF)
- ▶ General Managers (PAF)
- ▶ General Manager (CEPT)
- ▶ Chief Engineers
- ▶ Director (Foreign Post)
- ▶ Director Postal Services (HQ)

✎ “Director Postal Services (HQ)” added to the HOD definition by Addendum III — w.e.f. 09.06.2026

Note 2 — Sr. DDG (PAF) & GM (Finance)

Sr. DDG (PAF) — Head of Postal Accounts Wing in the Postal Directorate — and General Managers (Finance) shall exercise only such financial powers as contained in Schedule II-C which are relevant to their operational requirements. Director-level officers heading PAOs are treated as the Head of Office and specific powers are delegated under Schedule II-C to establish uniformity, as they head large establishments.

Note 3 — In-charge, Foreign Post

The In-charge of Foreign Post will exercise the delegated financial powers equivalent to HoD (Schedule II-A) / Independent Director (Schedule II-B) / Divisional Head (Schedule III), as the case may be.

Note 4 — Items where ONLY HOC can exercise powers

Within Schedule II-A, the following items shall be exercised only by the Head of the Postal Circle, i.e. HOC (and NOT by other HoDs):

Item Reference (Schedule II-A)	Subject Matter
4(ii), 4(iii), 4(iv)	Cash Awards to GDS / persons not in Govt. service (informers, anticipatory work)
11(xix)(a)	Outsourcing of services for Postal / RMS / MMS operations, security & housekeeping
15(i), 15(ii), 15(iv)	Purchases for PSD, Stores for works, Indents from Govt. Press
18(iv)	Dismantling of Building
22	Awards & Prizes
24(vii)	Other Revenue Expenditure (residuary head)
25(i), 25(ii)	Procurement of Operational & Inspection Vehicles (against condemnation)
27(iii), 27(iv), 27(v)	ICT — Computers under schemes, laptops for officers & for office use
28(i)	Heritage Assets — upgradation, procurement (Object Head 76)
31	Heritage Assets — upgradation n.e.c.
34(i)–(v)	Write-offs (revenue / stores / stock) & condemnation of motor vehicles
35(iii)	Conveyance of Mail by Road including RTN contract
37	Negotiated / Single-Tender purchase or contract

Note: The item numbers 11(xix)(a) etc. above follow the base-OM Note 4 numbering. In the operative Schedule II-A tables (and in this booklet), Outsourcing appears at Sl.10(xi)(a). Both refer to the same power.

Note 5 — Director (RAKNPA) & CGM (PD/BD/PLI)

Financial powers delegated to HOC ONLY under items 11(xix)(a), 15(i), 15(ii), 15(iv), 18(iv), 22, 24(vii), 27(iii), 27(iv), 27(v) and 28(i) of Schedule II-A shall ALSO be exercised by Director (RAKNPA) and CGM (PD / BD / PLI).

3. Conditions Governing Exercise of Powers

These delegated powers shall be exercised for incurring revenue or capital expenditure subject to the provisions contained in:

- ▶ Delegation of Financial Powers Rules, 2024
- ▶ General Financial Rules (GFR)
- ▶ Procurement Manuals
- ▶ Fundamental Rules & Supplementary Rules (FRSR)
- ▶ Departmental Code Books
- ▶ Instructions / orders by MoF or any Nodal Department / DoP

Further, these powers are subject to:

- ▶ Availability of funds (budgetary allotment)
- ▶ Observance of other prescribed formalities
- ▶ Necessity for the purchase being fully established on each occasion

◆ Five Restrictive Conditions — Verbatim from OM

(i) No work requiring sanction of higher authorities may be sanctioned by an officer by SPLITTING it into two or more distinct parts.

(ii) If a contract extends over a period, the TOTAL VALUE over its entire currency shall be taken as the value for applying the limit.

(iii) Limits apply not only to individual estimates but also to PROJECTS comprising one or more constituent estimates — total cost determines competence.

(iv) Under Rule 12(3) DFPR 2024, where Gazetted Officers are authorised, the HoD remains RESPONSIBLE for correctness, regularity and propriety of their decisions.

(v) All conditions / instructions / remarks attached to each item in the schedule shall be complied with.

◆ Para 6 & 7 — IFA Consultation Rule for Divisional Heads

Para 6 → For Divisional Heads: where Govt. rules, manuals, policies, guidelines, procedures or directives EXPLICITLY mandate IFA consultation, the matter must be referred to the concerned HOD / HOC.

Para 7 → All cases requiring approval of Secretary (Posts) / Hon'ble MoC shall first be cleared administratively by HOC in consultation with Circle IFA, then forwarded via concerned Member / DGPS to AS&FA.

Schedule II-A

FINANCIAL POWERS DELEGATED TO HEADS OF CIRCLES (HOC) & HEADS OF DEPARTMENT (HOD)

► Object Head 01 — Salaries

Includes pay of Government employees [FR 9(21)], honorarium to Government servants and stipend to interns; emoluments & allowances of Heads of State and other high dignitaries (including Sumptuary Allowance), salary of Departmental canteen staff, and leave encashment on LTC.

■ Sl. No. 1

(i) Salaries

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to provisions of FRSR, FHB, Nodal Ministry orders / instructions / rules — e.g. CCS (Medical Attendance) Rules, CCS Pension Rules etc.
Remarks	IFA consultation NOT required unless explicitly mandated by Government Rules, Manuals, Policies, Guidelines, Procedures, or Directions.

(ii) Ad-hoc Payment of Arrears of Pay and Allowances

✎ **AMENDED** by Addendum III — headline extent raised to Up to Rs. 5,00,000/-

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 5,00,000/-
Rules / Restrictions	(i) May sanction ad-hoc payment of arrears not exceeding Rs. 1 Lakh (HOC) and Rs. 50,000/- (HOD) where pay fixation was duly verified by the Account Officer concerned but arrear claims arising there from cannot be verified by the Circle Accounts Office due to destruction of records. (ii) Heads of Circles are competent to authorise investigation of claims for arrears of pay & allowances which are MORE THAN SIX YEARS OLD and in respect of which the connected records are not available in Circle Accounts Office, up to the delegated financial powers.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

(iii) Payment of Pay & Allowances claimed on behalf of Deceased Officials

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

(iv) Honorarium & Rewards to Government Servants

Extent of Powers	Up to the limit prescribed by the GoI / DoP
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP — DoPT OM No. 17011/3/97-Estt.(Allowance) dated 17.07.1998 and subsequent instructions. NOT exceeding Rs. 2,500/- in each case.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,500/- in each case.

► Object Head 02 — Wages

Includes wages of daily-rated workers and other similar staff.

■ Sl. No. 2

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to provisions of FRSR, FHB, Nodal Ministry orders / instructions / rules etc.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

► Object Head 04 — Pensionary Charges

All pensionary benefits — pensions & gratuity in all forms to Govt. employees, MPs, freedom fighters; contributions to service funds & CPF; leave encashment at retirement / death / termination; Government's NPS contribution. Does NOT include social security expenditure like old-age pension.

■ Sl. No. 3 — Pensionary Charges

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to provisions of FRSR, FHB and rules / orders / instructions issued by any Nodal Ministry / Department and DoP, and Pension Rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

► Object Head 05 — Rewards

Rewards given to Government employees in addition to their pay & allowances. Also payment of bonus and cash awards for Hindi Pratiyogita etc.

■ Sl. No. 4

(i) Cash Award to Postal Employees

In any one case for display of exceptional courage and devotion to duty in saving or protecting Government property in civil disturbances or in face of enemy action, or for detection of fraud.

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 10,000 → Rs. 25,000*

Extent of Powers	Rs. 25,000/-
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(ii) In any one case to GDS

For display of outstanding courage and devotion to duty in protecting Government property in civil disturbances or in face of enemy action.

Note: Cases of death or injury due to enemy action shall NOT be considered under these orders.

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 2,000 → Rs. 25,000*

Extent of Powers	Rs. 25,000/-
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iii) Rewards to persons not in Government Service

For furnishing information leading to detection and conviction of offenders in criminal cases.

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 1,000 → Rs. 10,000*

Extent of Powers	Rs. 10,000/-
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iv) Rewards to persons not in Govt. Service — Anticipatory Work

In any individual case to both official and non-official informers for especially good work in a particular case of detection and prosecution in connection with anticipatory activities.

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 1,000 → Rs. 10,000

Extent of Powers	Rs. 10,000/-
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► Object Head 06 — Medical Treatment

+ NEW Object Head inserted in Schedule II-A by Addendum III — w.e.f. 09.06.2026

It will include amount paid towards medical reimbursements / treatment of the Government employees / pensioners.

≡ Sl. No. 4(a) — New item below Sl. No. 4 — Reimbursement of Medical bills

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10 lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	As per the instructions issued by Ministry of Health & Family Welfare vide OM No. 11030/4/2026-EHS (8385264) dated 16.02.2026. Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation beyond Rs. 1,00,000/- in each case is required.

(v) Cash Award for Hindi Pratiyogita, etc.

Extent of Powers	As per the limit fixed by Nodal Department of GoI / DoP.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to ceiling limit / rates as decided by the Nodal Department of GoI / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

◆ Quick Snapshot — Object Head 05 (Rewards)

₹10,000 — Postal Employees (HOC or HOD)

₹2,000 — GDS [HOC ONLY]

₹1,000 — Outsiders for criminal-case info [HOC ONLY]

₹1,000 — Outsiders/officials for anticipatory work [HOC ONLY]

Hindi Pratiyogita — as per nodal department rate

IFA consultation always REQUIRED under Sl. No. 4.

► Object Head 07 — Allowances

Includes DA, HRA, Transport Allowance, Foreign Allowance, NPA, Deputation (Duty) Allowance, Personal Pay, Family Planning Allowance, Special Compensatory (Hill Areas) Allowance, Tribal Area Allowance, Hard Area Allowance, Headquarter Allowance, OTA, CEA & Tuition Fee reimbursement, Ration Allowance / cost of ration in cash, Constituency Allowance, Uniform & Clothing Allowance, Entertainment Allowance, Project Allowance, Special Compensatory (Remote Locality) Allowance, Bad Climate Allowance, Washing Allowance, Special Duty Allowance, Night Duty Allowance, Risk Allowance, Sunderban Allowance, Cash Handling Allowance, Caretaking Allowance, Split Duty Allowance, and any other allowance payable in addition to pay.

■ Sl. No. 5 — Expenses on Allowances mentioned in Object Head-07 of DFPR, 2024

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

► Object Head 08 — Leave Travel Concession (LTC)

Air / rail / bus fare / fare of any other mode of transport entitled under LTC Rules.

■ Sl. No. 6 — Leave Travel Concession

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Department / DoP. Example: DoP OM No. 31011/12/2022-I/CHA(IV) dated 29.08.2022 — in unavoidable circumstances where ticket booked from unauthorised travel agent / website, FAs of the Ministry / Department and HoD not below the rank of Joint Secretary in subordinate / attached offices are authorised to grant relaxation.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

► Object Head 09 — Training Expenses

Cost of training such as fees paid, contingencies, materials etc., for participating in training / workshops; EXCLUDES domestic or foreign travel expenses.

■ Sl. No. 7

(i) Training Expenses

Extent of Powers	Domestic: Rs. 2 Lakh in each case Foreign: Full Powers (prior approval of competent authority)
Rules / Restrictions	Rs. 2 Lakh in each case on any domestic training subject to nodal department / DoP instructions. Foreign training full powers subject to prior approval of competent authority [Secretary (Posts) / Hon'ble MoC / SCoS] per DoE OM No. 4(4)/E.Coord/2015 dated 05.01.2016 and subsequent instructions.
Remarks	Consultation with IFA REQUIRED.

(ii) Hiring outsourced services from Training Institution(s) – Director RAKNPA ONLY

For conducting specialised training programmes.

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 2 Crore per annum
Rules / Restrictions	IFW OM No. 6-2/2024-FA(P) dated 07.03.2024.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► Object Head 11 – Domestic Travel Expenses

Travel expenses on official tours and transfers of Government employees within India; TA/DA to non-official members for travel in India; transfer TA payable to pensioners at retirement.

■ Sl. No. 8

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

► Object Head 12 – Foreign Travel Expenses

Expenses on official tours and transfers of Government employees outside India; TA/DA to non-official members going abroad on official tour.

■ Sl. No. 9

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to prior approval of competent authority [Secretary (Posts) / Hon'ble MoC / SCoS] per DoE OM No. 1(1)/E.Coord/2015 dated 05.01.2016 and subsequent instructions.

Remarks	IFA consultation NOT required (as IFW consultation is invariably done before seeking approval of Secretary (Posts) / MoC / SCoS per DoE instruction).
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► Object Head 13 — Office Expenses

Includes ALL recurring & non-recurring contingent expenses on maintenance of office establishment — stationery, postage, courier, telephone, internet, cable, electricity, water, service agreements, security; outsourced office attendants / DEOs / housekeeping; liveries / uniforms; hot & cold weather charges; pest control; refreshments; books & periodicals; hospitality (incl. foreign delegates, gifts & souvenirs); conferences / seminars / workshops / meetings (study material, kits, refreshments, study tours). Also office equipment and furniture & fixtures NOT EXCEEDING the threshold of Rs. 1 Lakh OR 3 years of useful life, either of the two. Items EXCEEDING the threshold are 'capital' under Object Head 52 (Machinery & Equipment) / 74 (Furniture & Fixtures). Purchase of vehicles — irrespective of usage — is ALWAYS capital under Object Head 51 (Motor Vehicles).

■ Sl. No. 10

(i) Contingent Expenditure — Recurring

May sanction items of recurring contingent expenditure for which no scale or limit to the power of sanction is prescribed elsewhere.

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — raised, with new per-annum ceilings*

Extent of Powers	HOC — Rs. 5 Lakhs in each case, not exceeding Rs. 50 Lakhs per annum HOD — Rs. 3 Lakh in each case, not exceeding Rs. 30 Lakhs per annum
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 1,00,000/- in each case.

(ii) Contingent Expenditure — Non-Recurring

May sanction non-recurring contingent expenditure unless another limit is specified for any particular item in this Schedule, provided there is nothing novel, doubtful or irregular.

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — raised, with new per-annum ceilings*

Extent of Powers	HOC — Rs. 5 Lakhs in each case, not exceeding Rs. 50 Lakhs per annum HOD — Rs. 3 Lakh in each case, not exceeding Rs. 30 Lakhs per annum
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 1,00,000/- in each case.

(iii) Electric, Gas, Water, Telephone, Internet, Cable connection charges

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any ceiling limit prescribed by the Government of India.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(iv) Petty local purchases of articles of stationery**AMENDED by Addendum III — limits raised; Secretary (PSB) row added**

Extent of Powers	HOC — Rs. 15 Lakh per annum HOD — Rs. 10 Lakh per annum
Secretary (PSB)	Up to Rs. 10 Lakhs in each case, not exceeding Rs. 40 Lakhs per annum
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(v) Purchase of Fixtures & Furniture**AMENDED by Addendum II — w.e.f. 08.09.2025**

Extent of Powers	Full power is subject to the prescribed scale or other conditions that may be prescribed by the Government from time to time.
Rules / Restrictions	Furniture & fixtures NOT exceeding the threshold of Rs. 1 Lakh OR 3 years of useful life (either of the two) can only be procured under Object Head-13 (Office Expenses). Anything above goes to Object Head 74.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 75,000/- in each case.

(vi) Meals supplied to staff detained in office during emergency

For maintenance of regular & essential services in an emergency.

Extent of Powers	Up to ceiling limit of breakfast, lunch & dinner prescribed by DoE / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(vii) Working Lunch

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(viii) Local Purchase of Rubber Stamps

Extent of Powers	Full Powers subject to any orders issued from time to time.
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(ix) Purchase of Office Equipment (within threshold)

Not exceeding threshold of Rs. 1 Lakh or 3 years of useful life, either of the two.

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum II – w.e.f. 08.09.2025*

Rules / Restrictions	(i) Office Equipment does NOT include any item defined under Object Head-19 (Digital Equipment). (ii) Office equipment exceeding the threshold is classified as CAPITAL under Object Head 52 (Machinery & Equipment).
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 75,000/- in each case.

(x) Commission charges for Auction of Stores

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III – HOC Rs. 25,000 → Rs. 2 Lakh; HOD Rs. 10,000 → Rs. 1 Lakh*

Extent of Powers	HOC – up to Rs. 2 Lakh on any occasion HOD – up to Rs. 1 Lakh on any occasion
Rules / Restrictions	At rates not exceeding those paid by PWD / MSTC or the State Government concerned. Subject to any rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is not required unless explicitly mandated by Government Rules, Manuals, Policies, Guidelines, Procedures, or Directions etc.

(xi)(a) Outsourcing for Postal / RMS / MMS Operations + Security & Housekeeping

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum II – HOD limit of Rs. 5 Crore p.a. ADDED; IFA rule revised*

Extent of Powers	HOC: (i) Rs. 20 Crores per annum – for 7 HOCs [Delhi, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Telangana, UP & West Bengal Postal Circles]; (ii) Rs. 10 Crore per annum – for remaining HOCs.
HOD Limit (NEW)	Rs. 5 Crores per annum
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Expenditure should be within the allotment of funds to the Circles by the Directorate. In no case should expenditure be incurred without corresponding budget allotment. (ii) Outsourcing of services regulated as per workload, NOT exceeding the number of vacancies; a proper review at circle level and approval of CPMG, with consultation of CIFA, should be obtained for manpower to be deployed. (iii) A proper manuscript record of outsourced manpower deployed as per (ii) above is to be maintained to regulate and monitor the trend of expenditure and fund availability / budgetary exercises.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(xi)(b) Outsourcing of DEOs / MTS / Housekeeping for Admin & Operational requirements [Only Secretary (PSB)]

Extent of Powers	Rs. 1 Crore per annum
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP; regulated as per workload, not exceeding number of vacancies; manuscript record to be maintained.
Remarks	Consultation with IFA REQUIRED.

(xii) Stationery Allowance to GDS Staff

Stationery allowance per month for each ED Branch Office & ED Sub Office (for stationery cost — excluding carbon paper & sealing wax).

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Full Powers as authorised by Directorate from time to time. Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

(xiii) Stationery Allowance to GDS

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Full Powers as authorised by Directorate from time to time. Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

(xiv) Fixed Stationery Charges

Fixed stationery charges for any post office and for the office of the Superintendent of POs within the maximum admissible limit under the departmental formula (OTHER than ED BO/SO).

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Full Powers as authorised by Directorate from time to time. Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

(xv) Payment for provision of Escorts for conveyance of cash

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP. Circular No. 18/45(59)-CI dated 05.09.1960.
Remarks	If payment to Govt. / Police Department — IFA NOT required; otherwise IFA REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(xvi) Funeral Expenses

May sanction funeral expenses incidental to the death of departmental employees in Departmental Premises or on duty at outstations where bodies cannot be disposed of by relatives or friends.

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 25,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation NOT required.

(xvii) Foundation Stone-laying / Inauguration / Postal Week / Illumination

Foundation stone laying ceremony and opening of public buildings; other occasions like inauguration of new service, celebration of Postal Week, illumination of building etc.; including shamiana, refreshments, garlands, photographs etc.

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5 Lakhs → Rs. 10 Lakhs on each occasion

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10 Lakhs on each occasion
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP. The expenditure shall NOT exceed the limit including contingent expenses (invitations, shamianas, refreshments, garlands, photographs etc.).
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(xviii) Hospitality Expenses

Includes entertainment of foreign delegates, gifts & souvenirs, conferences / seminars / workshops / meetings (including study material / kits, refreshments, study tours).

AMENDED by Addendum II — w.e.f. 08.09.2025

Extent of Powers	Full financial powers up to ceiling limit prescribed by Government of India.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

◆ **Quick Snapshot — Object Head 13 (Office Expenses): HOC vs HOD (latest, Add-III)**

Recurring Contingent: HOC ₹5 L/case (cap ₹50 L p.a.) / HOD ₹3 L/case (cap ₹30 L p.a.) (IFA > ₹1 L)

Non-Recurring Contingent: HOC ₹5 L/case (cap ₹50 L p.a.) / HOD ₹3 L/case (cap ₹30 L p.a.) (IFA > ₹1 L)

Petty Stationery: HOC ₹15 L p.a. / HOD ₹10 L p.a. / Secretary(PSB) ₹10 L/case (cap ₹40 L p.a.)

Auction Commission: HOC ₹2 L / HOD ₹1 L on any occasion

Fixtures & Furniture: Full Powers (within threshold) — IFA > ₹75,000

Office Equipment (within threshold): IFA > ₹75,000

Outsourcing: HOC ₹20 Cr (7 circles)/₹10 Cr; HOD ₹5 Cr p.a.

Foundation Stone & Inauguration: ₹10 L per occasion (IFA > ₹2 L)

Funeral Expenses: ₹25,000 per case (No IFA)

Threshold for capital classification: ₹1 Lakh OR 3 years useful life



► Object Head 14 — Rent, Rates & Taxes (Land & Buildings)

Includes expenditure on rent for buildings (non-residential, residential or structures other than buildings), municipal rates & taxes, and lease charges for rented land & buildings where ownership is NOT transferable to Government. Where ownership IS transferable, lease charges are CAPITAL — booked under Object Head 'Land' or 'Buildings & Structures'.

■ Sl. No. 11

(i)(a) Renting of Accommodation

Includes Inspection Room / Rest Houses etc.

Officer	X-Class City	Y-Class City	Z-Class City
HOC	Rs. 10 Lakh/month for all classes	Rs. 10 Lakh/month for all classes	Rs. 10 Lakh/month for all classes
HOD	Rs. 2 Lakh/month	Rs. 1 Lakh/month	Rs. 50,000/month

Rules: Accommodation hired must be per the approved schedule of accommodation & scale. A certificate of reasonableness of rent must be obtained from Postal Civil Wing / Rent Control Authority. Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules. IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(i)(b) Renting of Accommodation for OFFICE-CUM-RESIDENCE

Officer	X-Class City	Y-Class City	Z-Class City
HOC	Rs. 10 Lakh/month for all classes	Rs. 10 Lakh/month for all classes	Rs. 10 Lakh/month for all classes
HOD	Rs. 2 Lakh/month	Rs. 1 Lakh/month	Rs. 50,000/month

Restrictive Conditions for Office-cum-Residence

- ▶ (i) NO accommodation may be hired under these powers at Delhi, Mumbai, Chennai, Shimla & Kolkata for any office entitled to general pool accommodation provided by the Ministry of Urban Development.
- ▶ (ii) Where CPWD operates, it shall invariably be consulted and required to give a certificate of non-availability of Government accommodation within reasonable time, and as to reasonableness of rent.
- ▶ (iii) Private accommodation normally hired for OFFICE PURPOSES ONLY. Where accommodation of proper scale is not available, accommodation may be hired for office-cum-residence / residence. Where hired for office-cum-residence — residential portion allotted to a specific post; the incumbent must occupy the residential portion until alternative accommodation is secured for the office also (vide SR 311, 312). Variation in plinth area up to 5% permitted.
- ▶ (iv) Standard License Fee recoverable for residential portion as per Govt. instructions.
- ▶ (v) Accommodation shall NOT be hired for more than 5 YEARS at a time.
- ▶ (vi) Subject to assessment of rent by appropriate Departmental Committee (FRAC).

- ▶ (vii) Renting of accommodation INCLUDES renting of land. Monetary limit depends on purpose of land use.
- ▶ (viii) Following are treated as OFFICE ACCOMMODATION — Garages, Store Godowns, Inspection Room, Inspection Quarters, Canteen & Recreating rooms, Dining halls, Dormitories, Libraries, Reading rooms, Training classes, Open ground for any authorised purpose. For garages — power determined by location (part of office or residence).

(i)(c) Renting for Residential & Other Purposes

X-Class City	Y-Class City	Z-Class City
Rs. 30,000/month	Rs. 20,000/month	Rs. 15,000/month

Rules: Same conditions as Sl. No. 11(i)(b). IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(i)(d) Renting of Residential Accommodation for Postal Staff in Project Areas / New Townships

May sanction renting of accommodation for Postal Staff stationed in these areas from Project authorities / Railways / State Govt. and Central Govt. Departments.

Restrictive Conditions

- ▶ (i) Rent of the building does NOT exceed 8% of the capital cost of the building.
- ▶ (ii) Type of accommodation must correspond to terms laid down by the Department for officials in various pay groups — variation up to 5% permitted.
- ▶ (iii) Percentage provision of residence of Postal Staff shall NOT exceed the percentage which the project authorities themselves provide to their own staff at that station.
- ▶ (iv) Recovery of rent from staff to whom these quarters are allotted shall be as per Government instructions; any DIFFERENCE between rent paid to landlord and rent recovered from allottees is borne by the Government.
- ▶ (v) While calculating non-returnable contributions / guarantees for post offices provided in project areas / townships, the LOSS involved in renting such residence shall also be taken into account.

IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(ii) Hiring of premises for Examinations / Events / Sports etc.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iii)(a) Municipal and other Rates & Taxes

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Dept / DoP. RESTRICTIVE CONDITION for Property Tax — to Municipalities / Panchayat / Local Boards in respect of rented buildings where owners fail to pay, the amount paid shall be RECOVERED IN FULL from future rents payable to the owner. (i) Recovery commences from rent bill for the month following the payment of tax. (ii) Power exercised only for buildings where prescribed-form leases have been executed by the Department with owners.
Remarks	(a) IFA NOT required for Municipal & other rates / taxes. (b) IFA REQUIRED for payment of Property Tax.



► Object Head 16 — Printing and Publication

Includes expenses on printing of valuables, audit & accounts reports, forms, stationery, office codes, manuals & other documents, newspapers & magazines (including e-books, e-magazines, digital printing, pen drives, CDs etc.); EXCLUDES expenses on printing of publicity material (which goes under Object Head 26 — Advertising & Publicity).

■ Sl. No. 12

(i)(a) Printing & Binding through Directorate of Printing (incl. stationery for printing)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(i)(b) Printing for essential and non-essential forms through Private Presses

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Exercised where rates do NOT exceed those in the Schedule of Rates maintained by Directorate of Printing. Printing of certain special forms and Foreign Post bag labels may, however, be sanctioned by HOC.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(i)(c) Others

✎ AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 1.5 Lakh → Rs. 5 Lakh per annum

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 5 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	These powers will be exercised in respect of all cases of printing at private presses where the rates to be paid do not exceed those admissible under the schedule of rates maintained for the time being by the Directorate of Printing. Printing of certain special forms and Foreign post bag labels may, however, be sanctioned by Heads of Circles.
Remarks	IFA consultation beyond Rs. 50,000/- in each case is required.

(ii) Official & Non-Official Publications

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules. (ii) Distribution of UNPRICED publications of the Central Government to be controlled by HOC; distribution list vetted by them before

	printing — vetting by officer NOT below the rank of Director. (iii) Maps produced by Survey of India purchased per rules issued by Surveyor General of India. (iv) NON-OFFICIAL publications include books, newspapers, periodicals etc.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(iii) Expenses on Newspapers & Magazines (incl. e-books, e-magazines, digital print, pen drive, CD)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

► Object Head 18 — Rent for Others

Expenses on rent for equipment & various items — office equipment, transport, computer & ancillary, communication, A/C / heating / refrigerating, security, broadcasting & recording, construction, agricultural, horticultural, medical equipment, furniture & fixtures. Also lease charges where ownership is NOT transferable to Government. Where ownership IS transferable — booked as CAPITAL under relevant Object Heads.

■ Sl. No. 13

(i) Renting of Equipment & Other Items

Office equipment, computers & ancillaries, communication, A/C / refrigerating, security, broadcasting & recording, furniture & fixtures etc.

Extent of Powers	Rs. 25 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(ii) Hiring vehicles in lieu of Inspection Vehicles / Staff Cars (against condemned ones)

Extent of Powers	Rs. 2 Lakh per month per vehicle
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to GFR 2017 and Directorate orders. Expenditure within budget allotment by Directorate; in no case without corresponding allotment.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iii) Hiring vehicles in EMERGENT Cases

Extent of Powers	Rs. 2 Lakh per case per month per vehicle, up to 3 months
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 50,000/- per case.

► Object Head 19 — Digital Equipment

Revenue expenditure on procurement / development of hardware & software where cost of individual item does NOT exceed Rs. 1 Lakh or 3 years of useful life, either of two. Threshold does NOT apply to consumables like toner & cartridge for printer — these are revenue expenditure.

■ Sl. No. 14 — Procurement of Digital Equipment (Object Head-19 of DFPR, 2024)

AMENDED by Addendum II — w.e.f. 08.09.2025

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Expenses in this Object Head are classified as REVENUE expenditure. (ii) Cost of the individual items does not exceed the threshold limit of one lakh rupees or three years of useful life, either of the two as decided by the Government from time to time. (iii) The threshold limit will, however, NOT apply to the consumables like toner and cartridge for printer — these shall be classified under revenue expenditure.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

► Object Head 21 — Material and Supplies

Expenses on supplies, materials & stores — medical, educational, agricultural, livestock; cleaning materials; hospital drugs & medicines, veterinary drugs, chemicals & fertilizers, lab supplies, spare parts, clothing & tentage.

■ Sl. No. 15

(i) Purchases for Postal Stores Depot [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Exercised for items to be stocked / issued through PSD. (ii) For items procured centrally per Directorate orders. (iii) Subject to availability of funds in sanctioned estimates, calling of competitive tenders, observance of formalities & purchase necessity being fully established each occasion.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(ii) Purchase of Stores required for Works [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	The sanction of the competent authority for executing the works required carries with it the sanction for incurring necessary expenditure on the Stores required for the works.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(iii) Purchase of Stores required for Working of Establishment / Instrument / Equipment / Apparatus

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	If stocked items are not available in the stores depots and due to urgency it is not possible to wait for supplies through the Stores Organisation, procurement may be made per the relevant provisions of GFR.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(iv) Purchase through indents from Government Press / Stationery Offices / Government Undertakings [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	In case of stocked items not available in stores depots and urgency prevents waiting for supplies through Stores Organisation.

Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.
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► Object Head 24 — Fuels and Lubricants

Expenditure on petrol, oil, lubricants and other fuels — CNG, diesel etc.

■ Sl. No. 16

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any ceiling limit of fuel charge prescribed by any Nodal Department.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

► Object Head 26 — Advertising and Publicity

Commission to agents for sale & printing of publicity material; advertising & publicity through print media, TV media, outdoor media, internet, mobile network, audio-visual publicity, fairs & exhibitions.

■ Sl. No. 17

(i) Advertising Charges — Advertisements to be released through BoC / DAVP only

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5 Lakh → Rs. 10 Lakh in each case

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(ii) Advertising & Publicity through various media (print/TV/outdoor/internet/mobile/AV/fairs & exhibitions)

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 2 Lakhs → Rs. 5 Lakh in each case

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 5 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

► Object Head 27 — Minor Civil & Electrical Works

Repairs and maintenance of minor civil & electrical works of office buildings, residential & other buildings; expenses on Running, Operation & Maintenance (ROM) of diesel gensets etc., maintained by CPWD.

■ Sl. No. 18

(i) Minor Civil & Electrical Works — Government Buildings

Extent of Powers	Rs. 10 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(ii) Minor Civil & Electrical Works — Rented Building

Extent of Powers	Rs. 5 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Such expenditure only if landlord refuses to meet charges himself; when building is released Government must have right to remove installation material added. (ii) Expenditure on repair/alteration of rented building shall be RECOVERED from rent payable per Para 9(i) of Part-A of DoP OM No. BDG-20/3/2021-BuildingDOP dated 18.02.2022 — sanctioning authority must ensure full recovery before completion of lease period. (iii) Undertaken only if there is reasonable certainty that the Department shall continue in possession of the building for the next 5 YEARS.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iii) Minor Electrical Works — Purchase & Installation of Removable Fittings (Rented Buildings)

Extent of Powers	Rs. 5 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules. Expenditure on repair/alteration of rented building must be recovered from rent payable per Para 9(i) of OM dated 18.02.2022.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iv) Dismantling of Building [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 50 Lakh
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.
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(v) ROM of Diesel Gensets etc.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

► Object Head 28 — Professional Services

Engagement of professionals, consultants, artists, banks etc. — legal services, consultancy fees, audit fees, teaching & training fees, payments to artists, remunerations to question setters / invigilators / guest speakers, payments to other departments for services rendered, payment to agencies for conducting departmental examinations.

■ Sl. No. 19**(i) Engagement / Hiring of Professionals (CAs, Artists, GST Consultants etc.)**

Extent of Powers	HOC — Rs. 1 Crore per annum HOD — Rs. 20 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(ii) Non-Recurring Contingent Expenditure for Market Survey / Studies / Hiring Consultants [CGM (BD), CGM (PD), CGM (PLI) and HOC]

AMENDED by Addendum III — HOC added to the delegates (earlier CGM BD/PD/PLI only)

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 50 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	May sanction non-recurring contingent expenditure for market survey / studies, hiring of consultants for functional requirements. Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(iii) Payment to Law Officers / Govt. Counsels / Barristers / Advocates / Pleaders / Arbitrators / Umpires

AMENDED by Addendum II — w.e.f. 08.09.2025

Extent of Powers	Full Powers subject to the ceiling limit / conditions prescribed by M/o Law & Justice.
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Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(iv) Other Legal Charges (Law Suits or Prosecution cases)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Powers for prosecution of law suits vest in the department of the Central Government or any subordinate authority authorised in this behalf. (ii) HOCs are competent to INITIATE PROSECUTION in non-cognizable criminal cases. (iii) Consent of DGPS is necessary for defence or institution of Civil Cases.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(v) Arbitration Cases

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Reference to arbitration is made in the name of the PRESIDENT, and by officers empowered to make such references under Article 77(2) of the Constitution or any other officer authorised in this behalf.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(vi) Expenses on Teaching & Training Fees to Professionals

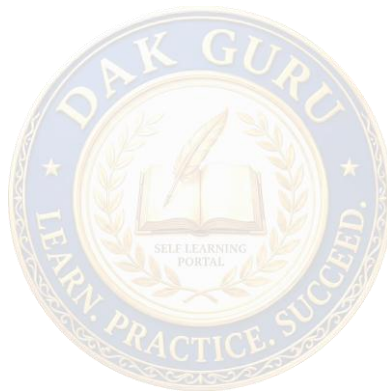
Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(vii) Payment to Artists & Remuneration to Question Setters / Invigilators / Guest Speakers

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(viii) Reimbursement of Legal Expenses incurred by Govt. servants in cases arising out of official duties

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.



► Object Head 35 — Repair and Maintenance

Repair & maintenance of office equipment incl. computers, digital equipment for office / functional use, furniture & fixtures (office/functional), vehicles (motor & non-motor like bicycle, rickshaw, carts, trolleys, boats etc.), infrastructural assets, tools & plants, arms & ammunitions. EXCLUDES upgradation, mid-life rehabilitation, retrofitting / reconditioning.

■ Sl. No. 20 — Repair & Maintenance for Official / Functional Use

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules. Covers: (i) office equipment incl. computers; (ii) digital equipment for office use; (iii) furniture & fixtures; (iv) tools & plants; (v) vehicles (motor & non-motor).
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

► Object Head 39 — Bank and Agency Charges

Bank service charges, agency charges, MDR charges, Direct Benefit Transfer charges to banks, and any other charges / convenience fee for performing monetary transactions.

■ Sl. No. 21

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

► Object Head 40 — Awards and Prizes

Awards & prizes given by the Government to eminent persons and organisations.

■ Sl. No. 22 — Awards & Prizes [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► Object Head 31 — Grants-in-Aid (General)

Grants-in-aid released for payments other than salaries and creation of capital assets; also expenditure on welfare activities.

Sl. No. 23

(i) Grant-in-Aid to Co-operative Societies for initial purchase of furniture etc.

Extent of Powers	Rs. 5,000/- for each society
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(ii) Grant of Interest-Free Recoverable Loan to Co-operative Society

Extent of Powers	Rs. 10,000/- for each co-operative society
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► Object Head 49 — Other Revenue Expenditure

Payment out of discretionary grant, other discounts, fees and fines, custom duty compensation, commitment charges, notional value of gifts, reimbursement of newspapers purchased / supplied to officer's residence, purchase / reimbursement of briefcase / ladies' purse to Government servants etc. Any other expenditure not classifiable under specified object heads will be debited here. Also covers schemes / sub-schemes / organisations not elsewhere classified.

Sl. No. 24

(i) Freight Charges

AMENDED by Addendum II — IFA consultation is NOT required (earlier: required beyond ₹2 L)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Condition: Sanction for airlifting should be accorded by the Secretary (Posts) only, in consultation with the Financial Adviser.
Remarks	IFA consultation is NOT required.

(ii) Demurrage / Wharfage Charges

Extent of Powers	Full Powers — but each case exceeding Rs. 50,000/- shall be reported to the Directorate.
Rules / Restrictions	Airlifting of stores shall be resorted to only in rare cases of EXTREME URGENCY, and such cases shall be reported to the Directorate ANNUALLY.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iii) Waiver of recovery of second Commission on IPOs presented after 6 months

Where the IPO is presented for payment after 6 months of issue, provided the delay is entirely due to the action of the public authority (Court of law, post offices etc.) or circumstances beyond control of the payee / purchaser — EXCEPT where payment is to be made to any Government / quasi-Government department.

Extent of Powers	Value of IPOs not exceeding Rs. 1,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to instructions / guidelines issued by Directorate under the latest Post Office Act and Rules / Regulations thereof.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iv) Compensation of Losses

Extent of Powers	Full Powers as per instructions issued by Directorate from time to time.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to general rules, HOC may sanction compensation: (1) For loss / damage to INLAND INSURED articles; (2) For loss of an inland uninsured registered letter, packet or parcel, or its contents, or any damage caused in the course of transmission through post.
Remarks	WITHOUT IFA consultation.

(v) Compensation for Insured & Registered Articles to/from Foreign Countries

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	All cases of dispute between Indian Post Office and any other postal administration shall be submitted to the Directorate.
Remarks	WITHOUT IFA consultation.

(vi) Reimbursement of Newspapers, Briefcase / Ladies' Purse to Govt. Servants

Extent of Powers	Full Powers subject to ceiling prescribed by Nodal Department / DoP.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to instructions / guidelines of Nodal Department / Postal Directorate.
Remarks	WITHOUT IFA consultation.

(vii) Any Other Expenditure not classifiable under specified Object Heads [HOC ONLY]

Also covers schemes / sub-schemes / organisations not elsewhere classified.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to instructions / guidelines issued by Postal Directorate.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.



► Object Head 51 — Motor Vehicles (CAPITAL)

Procurement of motor vehicles on road like buses, cars, trucks, motorcycles — IRRESPECTIVE of their usage.

■ Sl. No. 25

(i) Procurement of NEW Operational Vehicle against condemned operational vehicle [HOC & Director (RAKNPA) ONLY]

🔍 *Clarified by Addendum III — this power is delegated to HOC and Director (RAKNPA) only*

Extent of Powers	Full Powers for REPLACEMENT against condemnation only.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to instructions / guidelines issued in this matter by the Nodal Department / Department of Posts. D/o Post's OM No. 1-3/2016-MV dated 16.05.2018.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(ii) Procurement of NEW Inspection Vehicle against condemned inspection vehicle [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers for REPLACEMENT against condemnation only.
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to conditions laid down by DoP vide letter No. 17-1/2023-MV dated 29.02.2024 regarding price ceiling, make & model, geographical conditions, service facilities etc. (ii) Also subject to any prior / subsequent instructions of nodal department of GoI / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► Object Head 52 — Machinery and Equipment (CAPITAL)

■ Sl. No. 26

(i) Fire Protection Appliances

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Fire Protection appliances whose cost exceeds Rs. 1 Lakh OR 3 years useful life (either of two) must be booked under this head. Full Powers subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFW consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(ii) Procurement of Machinery & Equipment (other than motor vehicles & ICT equipment), electrical & electronic equipment etc.**AMENDED by Addendum II – w.e.f. 08.09.2025**

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Machinery & equipment, the cost of which exceeds one lakh rupees or three years of useful life, either of the two, need to be booked under this head. Full Powers are subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

► Object Head 71 – Information, Computer & Telecom (ICT) Equipment (CAPITAL)

Computer hardware & telecom devices (computers / laptops, projectors etc.) and computer software exceeding Rs. 1 Lakh OR 3 years useful life (either of two); also electromagnetic spectrum used in transmission of sound, data & television.

■ Sl. No. 27**(i) Desktop Computers and Peripherals for Official Use under NON-SCHEME****AMENDED by Addendum II – “and peripherals” added**

Extent of Powers	Rs. 5 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(ii) Desktop Computers and Peripherals for REPLACEMENT under non-scheme**AMENDED by Addendum II – “and peripherals” added**

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 20 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(iii) Desktops & Peripherals for Computerisation under SCHEMES (POs / PAOs / Admin offices) [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers (under administratively-approved Scheme conveyed by Directorate)
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Rules / Restrictions	(i) Funds allotted by Directorate under this plan head; allotted funds to be utilised within stipulated period. (ii) Expenditure sanction processed per codal provisions & sanctions issued by HOC. (iii) Procurement per GFR, 2017.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iv) Laptop / Notebook & similar devices for eligible officers on functional requirement [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Cost of device: Rs. 1,00,000/- + taxes. For Make-in-India (MII) component >40%, the ceiling shall be Rs. 1,30,000/- + taxes (inclusive of cost of standard software).
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to DoE OM No. 03(20)/2022-E.II(A) dated 21.02.2023 and subsequent DoE instructions.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(v) Laptops for Office Use Only (NOT for issue to individual officers)

AMENDED by Addendum III – HOC Rs. 5 L → Rs. 50 Lakh p.a.; HOD Rs. 25 Lakh p.a. added

Extent of Powers	HOC – Up to Rs. 50 Lakh per annum HOD – Up to Rs. 25 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to urgency / necessity of functional / official requirement to be recorded by HOC / HOD only. (ii) Procurement process as per GFR has to be followed. (iii) Cost of a laptop shall NOT be more than the ceiling limit prescribed by DoE OM No. 03(20)/2022-E.II(A) dated 21.07.2023 for eligible officers.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

► Object Head 72 — Buildings and Structures (CAPITAL)

Office buildings, residential buildings, other buildings & structures (hospitals, laboratories, auditoria, lighthouses, shelters etc.), public monuments (statues, fountains at public places), and land improvement.

■ Sl. No. 28

(i) Sanction of Project Estimates — Construction / Reconstruction of Postal Buildings or Staff Quarters

✂ AMENDED by Addendum III — HOC Rs. 10 Cr → Rs. 20 Cr; HOD Rs. 10 Cr added

Extent of Powers	HOC — Up to Rs. 20 Crores HOD — Up to Rs. 10 Crores
Rules / Restrictions	RESTRICTIVE CONDITIONS: (i) Powers do NOT apply to acquisition / purchase of land under an estimate forming part of a project not sanctioned in advance as a special case. (ii) Residential buildings — scale of accommodation not to exceed that prescribed for different classes of staff. NOTE 1: limit includes ETP charges for works by CPWD, State PWD or other agencies. NOTE 2: When applied to works by Civil Wing or to electric / sanitary / water-supply works carried out departmentally, the limit is INCLUSIVE of freight but EXCLUSIVE of share of establishment & store-keeping charges. (iii) HOC/HOD powers under this rule also apply to sanitary, water supply & electric installations in buildings. (iv) While sanctioning projects: (a) For office buildings — follow scales for post offices, RMS offices, Rest Houses and other prescribed standards; total floor area approved per the SOA in consultation with IFA. (b) For residential buildings — plinth area per types of quarters in consultation with IFA; variation up to 5% allowed due to structural consideration.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(ii) Addition, Alteration including Replacement of Installations to NON-RESIDENTIAL Buildings

✂ AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 2 Cr → Rs. 5 Cr (HOC & HOD); heritage buildings Rs. 20 Cr (HOC only)

Extent of Powers	(HOC and HOD) Up to Rs. 5 Crores excluding overhead charges in each case. In case of heritage buildings, up to Rs. 20 Crores to HOC only, excluding overhead charges in each case.
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Expenditure should be incurred subject to instructions issued by the Directorate from time to time. (ii) The powers of a Head of Circle / Head of Department under this rule also apply in respect of sanitary, water supply and electric installations in buildings including residential buildings. The limits laid down in rule when applied to works of electric, sanitary and water

	supply installations carried out departmentally should be taken as inclusive of freight but exclusive of share of establishment and store-keeping charges.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(iii) Addition, Alteration including Replacement of Installations to RESIDENTIAL Buildings

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 2 Crores excluding overhead charges in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Same conditions as (ii) above. (Residential-building limit not separately revised by Addendum III.)
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

■ Sl. No. 29 — Procurement of Infrastructural Assets

Extent of Powers	Rs. 2 Crores in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2 Lakh.

► Object Head 74 — Furniture and Fixtures (CAPITAL)

Purchase of furniture & fixtures EXCEEDING the threshold of Rs. 1 Lakh OR 3 years of useful life, either of two — for office use and functional use.

■ Sl. No. 30 — Procurement of Furniture & Fixture for Official / Functional Use

AMENDED by Addendum II — w.e.f. 08.09.2025

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Conditions: (i) Furniture and fixtures EXCEEDING threshold limit of one lakh rupees or three years of useful life, either of the two, can only be procured in this Object Head-74 [Furniture & Fixtures]. (ii) Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required BEYOND Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

► Object Head 76 — Upgradation / Heritage Assets (n.e.c.)

Rehabilitation, overhaul, retrofitting of heritage assets — recognised & recorded in the asset register at the nominal value of Rs. 1/- — and upgradation 'not elsewhere classified'. Also expenses on procurement of items of fine art and of cultural & archaeological importance.

■ Sl. No. 31 [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	As per the limit fixed by Nodal Department of GoI / DoP.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► Object Head 77 — Other Fixed Assets (CAPITAL)

Procurement of other fixed assets like library books & publications, trees, crops & plants (whose natural growth & regeneration is under direct control / responsibility / management of institutional units), non-motor vehicles like bicycle, rickshaw, cart, trolleys, boats etc.

■ Sl. No. 32

(i) Battery / Electric Cart (battery-operated carts, trolleys etc. for conveyance of mail — NOT motor vehicles)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2 Lakh.

(ii) Library Books / Publications, Trees, Crops & Plants

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2 Lakh.

► Object Head 55 — Advances

■ Sl. No. 33

(i) Permanent Advance

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum II — IFA required (plain); “beyond ₹2 Lakh” removed*

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	(i) To be regulated in accordance with Rule-322 of GFR 2017 read with Rule 342 and 343 of FHB Vol I. Amount of Advance will be based on the average monthly contingent expenditure of the office for the preceding 12 months. (ii) Subject to any rules / instructions issued by Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	IFA Consultation is required.

(ii) Personal Computer Advance

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

(iii) House Building Advances

Extent of Powers	Full Powers subject to instructions issued by Government of India.
Rules / Restrictions	Regulated with reference to orders issued from time to time by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.
Remarks	IFA consultation not required unless explicitly mandated.

► Object Head 64 — Write-Offs**■ Sl. No. 34****(i) Write-off of Loss of Revenue [HOC ONLY]**

Extent of Powers	Rs. 5,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to conditions in DoE OM No. 01(14)/2016-E.II(A) (Part-III) dated 01.04.2024. Powers exercised per GFR provisions, provided: (a) Loss does not disclose a defect in rules / procedure requiring higher-authority or MoF amendment; (b) No serious negligence by any Govt. servant calling for disciplinary action; (c) Before write-off — thorough investigation; lessons applied to prevent recurrence; (d) QUARTERLY statement of write-off losses submitted to Integrated Finance Division.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(ii) Write-off of Irrecoverable Losses of Stores / Public Money [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Rs. 50,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Similar conditions as Sl. No. 34(i) above.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iii) Write-off due to Deficiencies & Depreciation in Stores (other than motor vehicle / motorcycle) [HOC ONLY]

Includes losses on food grains, sugar etc. in the stock account.

Extent of Powers	Rs. 50,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Similar conditions as Sl. No. 34(i) above.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(iv) Mature Condemnation of Motor Vehicle / Motorcycle [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to lives of various types of vehicle in terms of distance run and length of use as prescribed by DoE vide OM No. 01(14)/2016-E.II(A) (Part-III) dated 01.04.2024.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

(v) Condemnation of Vehicles reaching 15 years of age [HOC ONLY]

Extent of Powers	Full Powers to scrap vehicles which have reached 15 years of age through Registered Vehicle Scrapping Facility (RVSF) only, established per Ministry of Road Transport & Highways (MoRTH) guidelines.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.



◆ Write-Off Powers — “Each Case” Interpretation

“Each case” = total value of stores to be written off on ONE occasion.

Losses arising out of ONE INCIDENT shall NOT be split up and written off on different dates to avoid sanction of higher authority.

Losses due to ONE specific cause (fire, theft, flood etc.) shall be written off at ONE TIME only.

No objection to losses from MORE THAN ONE CAUSE being written off at one time.

Competence depends on amount written off EACH TIME.

Other Financial Powers of HOC / HOD

► SL. No. 35 — Conveyance of Mails

(i) By Rail

Extent of Powers	Full Powers (includes seasonal mail conveyance like exam materials, textbooks etc.)
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Carriage of mails by Rail at rates approved by DoP in consultation with Railways — including running of special trains. (ii) Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(ii) By Air

Extent of Powers	Full Powers (includes seasonal mail conveyance like exam materials, textbooks etc.)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to condition that payment is made at rates fixed under the terms of agreement entered with the carrier by the Department.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(iii) By Road including RTN Contract

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — HOC Rs. 10 Cr → Rs. 20 Cr; HOD Rs. 1 Cr per contract added*

Extent of Powers	HOC — Up to Rs. 20 Crores per contract HOD — Up to Rs. 1 Crore per contract
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- in each case.

(iv) By Other Means

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 2,50,000 → Rs. 5 Lakh per month (both limbs)*

Extent of Powers	(i) Up to Rs. 5 Lakh per month on each route without inviting tenders in case of EMERGENCY ONLY — provided that work is temporarily entrusted to a nominee of the Ministry of External Affairs / State Government / monopolist transport operator / Civil Aviation company. (ii) Up to Rs. 5 Lakh per month in each case for a period NOT EXCEEDING 3 MONTHS without calling tenders in emergency cases where normal tender procedure is likely to cause delay or administrative
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	inconvenience — subject to reasonableness of the rate being certified by the sanctioning authority.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(v) Conveyance of Mails to Foreign Countries by Non-Contract Steamer (dispatch by one ship)

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5 Lakhs → Rs. 10 Lakhs

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10 Lakhs (includes seasonal mail conveyance requirement like exam material, distribution, textbooks etc.)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

(vi) All Other Charges for Carriage of Mails

Except where any general or special directions of Government are infringed or where the matter is not free from doubt. May sanction payment of bill of haulage charges in respect of special trains — subject to no departure from rates sanctioned by Railway Department.

Extent of Financial Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

(vii) Contingent Charges for Diversion & Conveyance of Mails (Breaches, Floods, Accidents on Rail / Road)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers (includes seasonal mail conveyance)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

► Sl. No. 36 — Refunds

(a) Earnest Money

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Refund of earnest money deposited by tenderers in respect of contracts immediately after their tenders are rejected. (ii) Refund

	of earnest money deposited by the successful tenderer after the agreement is executed and security for due performance is deposited — unless otherwise provided in the contract itself.
Remarks	IFA consultation NOT required.

(b) Postage Charges

Extent of Powers	Full Powers subject to the following.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

Key Refund Heads under (b)

Sub-Item	Refund For	Reduction / Condition
(i)(a)	Unused but spoilt postage stamps (ordinary & service)	6¼% reduction; only on COMPLETE SHEETS
(i)(b)	Unused but spoilt postal stationery	20% reduction; only on COMPLETE REAM
(i)(c)	Postage stamps found loose in letter boxes / PO counters	Refund of face value
(i)(d)	Franking machine impressions made in error	5% deduction; envelope/wrapper produced; claim within 3 MONTHS
(i)(e)	Unused units of postage in condemned / discontinued franking machine	Claim within 3 MONTHS of condemnation / discontinuance
(ii)(a)	Postage on articles maliciously sent unpaid	Original cover/wrapper required (except foreign articles)
(ii)(b)	Commission on MO wrongly accepted by PO	Where there is no MO exchange at destination
(ii)(c)	Unused postcards / empty embossed envelopes / coins / currency notes	Found in letter boxes or PO counters; value already credited
(ii)(d)	Amounts overpaid / short-paid in PO transactions	Found in excess in PO account
(ii)(e)	VP article amount recovered from addressee	Where PMG is satisfied article was sent to defraud addressee

Sub-Item	Refund For	Reduction / Condition
(ii)(f)	Perishable & dead articles sold by RLO	Refund of amount
(ii)(g)	Loss due to misappropriation by Postal official / outsider fraud	Per Clause 1 Rule 223 P&T Manual Vol. V
(ii)(h)	Amount of MO (incl. commission to remitter)	Where money for issue of MO was misappropriated [Rule 222(2)]
(ii)(i)	Loss caused to remitter of MO / TMO by deception	Up to amount HOC can write off in cash/stamp loss
(ii)(j)	Commission on TMO/MO not paid due to service fault	Only in very exceptional circumstances
(ii)(k)	Refunds to sureties of Postal official	When loss recovered subsequently
(ii)(l)	Supplementary fee on TMO where telegraphic charges refunded	Due to fault of service
(ii)(m)	Lost British Postal Orders — value & poundage	Per Article 319 P&T Initial Account Code Vol. I
(ii)(n)	Air surcharges / difference between airmail & surface postage	—
(ii)(o)	Franking impressions on articles undeliverable due to service suspension	Prior public notice not given; envelopes/labels surrendered; claim within 3 MONTHS

Note: Powers at (d) and (e) above may be delegated by HOC to Sr. Supdt. of POs and First-class Postmasters (incl. Presidency Postmasters & Supdt. of POs) subject to the same conditions. Power at (o) above may be similarly delegated by HOC to Supdt. of POs and First-Class Postmasters.

(c) Refund of Fee for Duplicate SB Passbook

May sanction refund of the fee already realised under Rule 22 of the Post Office Savings Bank — where original passbook is found before duplicate is actually issued and the loss was reported under bona-fide misapprehension.

Rules / Restrictions	Subject to instructions / guidelines issued by MoF / Postal Directorate.
Remarks	IFA consultation NOT required.

(d) Refund to sender of mis-delivered uninsured postal article

Amount involved due to loss of contents AFTER recovery from wrong recipient; and compensation for loss of uninsured postal articles where loss / theft by tampering has been established and flat-rate compensation has been decided by the Directorate.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to instructions / guidelines of Postal Directorate.
Remarks	WITHOUT IFA consultation.

(e) Refund of Advertisement Charges

Extent of Powers	HOC — Rs. 50,000/- per case HOD — Rs. 10,000/- per case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
Remarks	IFA consultation REQUIRED.

► **Sl. No. 37 — Sanction of Expenditure for Purchases / Contracts on NEGOTIATED or SINGLE TENDER Basis**

✎ *AMENDED by Addendum III — HOD Rs. 10 Lakh per case added (earlier HOC only)*

Extent of Powers	HOC — Up to Rs. 50 Lakh in each case HOD — Up to Rs. 10 Lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules. NOTE: A LIMITED TENDER or OPEN TENDER which results in only one effective offer shall be treated as a SINGLE TENDER for this purpose.
Remarks	IFA consultation is required.

Schedule III

FINANCIAL POWERS DELEGATED TO HEADS OF POSTAL DIVISIONS, HEADS OF RMS DIVISIONS, CHIEF POSTMASTER (GPO), SUPERINTENDENT PSDs AND SENIOR POSTMASTER

🔍 Coverage EXPANDED by Addendum II — now includes Heads of RMS Divisions, Chief Postmaster (GPO), Superintendent PSDs & Senior Postmaster

◆ Governing IFA Rule — Para 6 of the Delegation Order

Across ALL Schedule III items, the same general remark applies:

→ If Government rules, manuals, policies, guidelines, procedures or directives EXPLICITLY mandate IFA consultation, the matter must be referred to the concerned HOD / HOC.

→ Divisional Heads do NOT have direct IFA consultation channels for Schedule III items.

► Object Head 01 — Salaries

☰ Sl. No. 1 — Salaries

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to the provisions of FRSR, FHB, Nodal Ministry orders / instructions / rules — e.g. CCS (Medical Attendance) Rules, CCS Pension Rules etc.
Remarks	If Government rules, manuals, policies, guidelines, procedures or directives EXPLICITLY mandate IFA consultation, the matter must be referred to the concerned HOD / HOC.

► Object Head 02 — Wages

☰ Sl. No. 2 — Wages

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to the provisions of FRSR, FHB, Nodal Ministry orders / instructions / rules — e.g. CCS (Medical Attendance) Rules, CCS Pension Rules etc.
Remarks	If Government rules, manuals, policies, guidelines, procedures or directives EXPLICITLY mandate IFA consultation, the matter must be referred to the concerned HOD / HOC.

► Object Head 04 — Pensionary Charges

■ Sl. No. 3 — Pensionary Charges

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to provisions of FRSR, FHB and rules / orders / instructions issued by any Nodal Ministry / Department and DoP.
Remarks	If Govt. rules etc. explicitly mandate IFA consultation, refer to HOD / HOC.

► Object Head 06 — Medical Treatment

+ NEW Object Head inserted in Schedule III by Addendum III — w.e.f. 09.06.2026

It will include amount paid towards medical reimbursements / treatment of the Government employees / pensioners.

■ Sl. No. 3(a) — New item below Sl. No. 3 — Reimbursement of Medical bills

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 2 lakh in each case
Rules / Restrictions	As per the instructions issued by Ministry of Health & Family Welfare vide OM No. 11030/4/2026-EHS (8385264) dated 16.02.2026. Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

► Object Head 07 — Allowances

■ Sl. No. 4 — All allowances under Object Head-07 (Allowances)

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	If Govt. rules etc. explicitly mandate IFA consultation, refer to HOD / HOC.

► Object Head 08 — Leave Travel Concession

■ Sl. No. 5 — Leave Travel Concession

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Department / DoP. Example: DoPT OM No. 31011/12/2022-Estt.A-IV dated 29.08.2022 — in unavoidable circumstances where ticket is booked through unauthorised travel agent / website, the FAs of

	the Ministry / Department and HoD not below the rank of Joint Secretary in subordinate / attached offices are authorised to grant relaxation.
Remarks	If Govt. rules etc. explicitly mandate IFA consultation, refer to HOD / HOC.

► Object Head 11 — Domestic Travel Expenses

≡ Sl. No. 6 — Domestic Travel Expenses

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to rules / instructions of Nodal Department / DoP.
Remarks	If Govt. rules etc. explicitly mandate IFA consultation, refer to HOD / HOC.

► Object Head 12 — Foreign Travel Expenses

≡ Sl. No. 7 — Foreign Travel Expenses

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Full Powers subject to prior approval of competent authority [Secretary (Posts) / Hon'ble MoC / SCoS] per DoE OM No. 4(4)/E.Coord/2015 dated 05.01.2016 and subsequent instructions.

► Object Head 13 — Office Expenses

■ Sl. No. 8

(i) Contingent Charges (Non-Recurring)

May sanction non-recurring contingent expenditure unless another limit is specified for any particular item in this Schedule — provided there is nothing novel, doubtful or irregular in the character of the expenditure — subject to provisions of DFPR 2024 and availability of funds.

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 10,000 → Rs. 25,000/case, with annual ceiling

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 25,000/- in each case, not exceeding Rs. 3 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

(ii) Electric, Gas, Water, Telephone, Internet, Cable connection charges

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any ceiling limit prescribed by the Government of India.

(iii) Hot & Cold Weather Charges

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(iv) Purchase of Fixtures & Furniture

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 2 Lakh p.a. → Rs. 1 Lakh/case (cap Rs. 10 Lakh p.a.)

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 1,00,000/- in each case, not exceeding Rs. 10 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to the prescribed scale or other conditions that may be prescribed by the Nodal Department / DoP from time to time. (ii) Furniture & fixtures NOT exceeding the threshold limit of one lakh rupees or three years of useful life, either of the two, can only be procured under Object Head-13 (Office Expenses).

(v) Holding of Customer Meets

Preparation of folders, hiring / transport of equipment / staff, tea/coffee/soft drinks & snacks, and other activities necessary for conducting customer meets.

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 10,000 → Rs. 25,000/meet; Working Lunch added; annual cap Rs. 1 Lakh

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 25,000/- for each meet, with a ceiling of Rs. 5,000/- on hiring, Rs. 200/- per head on tea & snacks etc., and Rs. 100/- per head on stationery & ancillaries. Working Lunch — Rs. 500/head. (with a ceiling limit of Rs. 1 lakh per annum.)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by Postal Directorate.

(vi) Purchase of Office Equipment (within threshold)

Not exceeding the threshold of Rs. 1 Lakh or 3 years of useful life, either of the two.

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5,000 → Rs. 50,000/case (cap Rs. 5 Lakh p.a.)

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 50,000/- in each case, not exceeding Rs. 5 lakhs per annum
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP. (ii) Office Equipment does NOT include any kind of Computer. (iii) Office equipment exceeding the threshold limit is classified as 'Capital' expenditure under Object Head 52 (Machinery & Equipment).

(vii) Fixed Stationery Charges

Extent of Powers	Full Powers as authorised by the Directorate from time to time.
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(viii) Emergent Purchase of Stock & Stationery Items not ordinarily available

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 50,000 → Rs. 2 Lakhs per annum

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 2 Lakhs per annum (after obtaining non-availability certificate from PSD)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

(ix) Expenditure on Carriage of Mails by modes other than Rail & Air

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 10,000/month → Rs. 50,000/case (cap Rs. 6 Lakh p.a.)

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 50,000/- in each case, not exceeding Rs. 6 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

(x) Embedding of Cash / Mail Chests, Purchase of Technical Books / Maps, Painting of Letter Boxes / Sign Boards / Notice Boards etc.

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(xi) Police Escort Charges for Carriage of Cash

+ NEW ITEM — inserted by Addendum II, w.e.f. 08.09.2025

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

◆ Quick Snapshot — DH Office Expenses (OH-13) (latest, Add-III)

Non-recurring contingent — ₹25,000/case (cap ₹3 L p.a.)
 Hot/Cold Weather — ₹10,000 per case
 Fixtures/Furniture — ₹1 Lakh/case (cap ₹10 L p.a.)
 Customer Meets — ₹25,000/meet (hiring ₹5,000, tea ₹200/head, stationery ₹100/head, working lunch ₹500/head; cap ₹1 L p.a.)
 Office Equipment — ₹50,000/case (cap ₹5 L p.a.; excludes computers)
 Emergent Stock/Stationery — ₹2 Lakh p.a. (PSD non-availability certificate required)
 Carriage of mails (non-rail/air) — ₹50,000/case (cap ₹6 L p.a.)
 Embedding chests / painting boxes / books — ₹10,000 per case
 Police escort for cash — Full Powers [NEW ITEM, Add-II]

► Object Head 14 — Rent, Rates & Taxes (Land & Buildings)

■ Sl. No. 9

(i) Renting of Buildings for Office Use (Without FRAC)

X-Class Cities	Y-Class Cities	Z-Class Cities
Up to Rs. 15,000/-/month	Up to Rs. 12,000/-/month	Up to Rs. 8,000/-/month

Conditions

- ▶ (i) Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
- ▶ (ii) Hiring shall be per SOA (Schedule of Accommodation), prevailing market rent paid by Government / Semi-Government organisations for similar accommodation, and Government-approved rate of rent for the locality.
- ▶ (iii) A QUARTERLY REPORT on all such hiring cases shall be sent to the PMG with a COPY to the DAP. These cases shall also be inspected during regular inspection.

(ii) Hiring of Accommodation for holding Examinations & for other purposes e.g. holding Customer Meet etc.

✂ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5,000 → Rs. 10,000/- in each case*

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 10,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

(iii) Rates & Taxes Legally Assessed on Buildings & Vehicles in their charge

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

► Object Head 16 — Printing and Publication

■ Sl. No. 10 — Printing & Binding

(i) Printing of Rate Charts, Mailers, Brochures & Other Publicity Material

For publicising products, services and initiatives of the Department — and distribution to post offices, marketing executives and customers.

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 20,000/- per annum (all activities taken together)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(ii) Printing & Binding (general)

Extent of Powers	Rs. 2 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

► Object Head 18 — Rent for Others**■ Sl. No. 11 — Renting of Equipment & Other Items**

Office equipment, computer & ancillary equipment, communication equipment, A/C / heating / refrigerating, security equipment, broadcasting & recording, furniture & fixtures etc.

Extent of Powers	As per the powers prescribed under the applicable rules — subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.
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► Object Head 19 — Digital Equipment**+ NEW ITEM — inserted by Addendum II, w.e.f. 08.09.2025**

It will include expenses to be classified as revenue expenditure on procurement or development of hardware and software where the cost of individual item does not exceed the threshold limit of one lakh rupees or three years of useful life, either of the two as decided by the Government from time to time. The threshold limit will, however, not apply to the consumables like toner and cartridge for printer which shall be classified under revenue expenditure.

■ Sl. No. 15 — Procurement of Digital Equipment as defined in Object Head-19 of DFPR, 2024

Extent of Powers	Upto Rs. 20,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Expenses in this Object Head are classified as revenue expenditure. (ii) Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

► Object Head 24 — Fuels and Lubricants**+ NEW ITEM — inserted by Addendum II, w.e.f. 08.09.2025**

It will include expenditure on petrol, oil, lubricants and other fuels like CNG, diesel etc.

■ Sl. No. 16 — Expenses on petrol, oil, lubricants and other fuels like CNG, diesel etc.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instruction issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

► Object Head 26 — Advertising and Publicity

+ NEW ITEM — inserted by Addendum II, w.e.f. 08.09.2025

It will include expenses including commission to agents for sale and printing of publicity material on advertising and publicity through various media such as print media, TV media or outdoor media or Internet or mobile network or other audio-visual publicity or fairs and exhibition.

■ Sl. No. 17 — Expenses on advertising and publicity through various media

Extent of Powers	Upto Rs. 20,000/- in each case
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

► Object Head 27 — Minor Civil & Electrical Works

■ Sl. No. 12

(i) Minor Civil & Electrical Works — Government Buildings

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 50,000 → Rs. 1 Lakh/case (cap Rs. 5 Lakh p.a.)

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 1,00,000/- in each case, not exceeding Rs. 5 lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

(ii) Minor Civil & Electrical Works — Rented Building

AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5,000 → Rs. 30,000/case (non-scheme) & Rs. 50,000/case (scheme)

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 30,000/- in each case for non-scheme. Up to Rs. 50,000/- in each case for scheme.
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Such expenditure may be incurred only if the landlord refused to meet the charges himself and when the building is released, Government should have the right to remove the installation material added to the building. (ii) Any expenditure incurred on repair / alteration of hired / rented building should be recovered from the rent payable in terms of Para 9(j) of Part-A of this Department's OM No. BDG-20/3/2021-BuildingDOP dated 18.02.2022. (iii) The annual limits apply to the expenditure on each building. (iv) Such expenditure should be undertaken only if the landlord refuses to meet the charges himself, or in accordance with the agreement of hiring the building and there is reasonable certainty that Department shall continue in possession of building for next five years. These powers are subject to any rules / instructions / policies issued by any Nodal Department / DoP from time to time.

(iii) Minor Electrical Works — Purchase & Installation of Removable Fittings (Rented Buildings)

✂ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 5,000 → Rs. 30,000/case (cap Rs. 3 Lakh p.a.)*

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 30,000/- in each case, not exceeding Rs. 3 Lakh per annum
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP. (ii) Any expenditure incurred on repair / alteration of hired / rented building should be recovered from the rent payable in terms of Para 9(j) of Part-A of this Department's OM No. BDG-20/3/2021-BuildingDOP dated 18.02.2022.

► Object Head 28 — Professional Services

≡ Sl. No. 13 — Legal Charges & obtaining copies of judgements

Extent of Powers	May incur an amount payable at the rate and scale fixed by the Government from time to time.
Rules / Restrictions	(i) Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules. (ii) Subject to maximum ceiling of Rs. 2 Lakh in each case.

► Object Head 29 — Repair and Maintenance

✚ *Object Head inserted in Sch. III by Addendum II; limit revised by Addendum III*

It will include expenses on repair and maintenance (including all maintenance contract) of equipment such as machinery and equipment, office equipment, equipment for other functional use, digital equipment for office use, digital equipment for functional use, furniture and fixtures for office, furniture and fixtures for other functional use, vehicles (including motor vehicles and non-motor vehicles like bicycle, rickshaw, carts, trolleys and boat, etc., for office or functional use), infrastructural assets (preventive & operating maintenance of infrastructural assets other than minor civil and electrical works like lines, bridges, rolling stocks of railways, roads, highways, ports, ships, aircraft, helicopters, radars, hovercrafts, airports or other infrastructures), tools and plants, arms and ammunitions etc. — but EXCLUDE expenditure on upgradation, midlife rehabilitation, retrofitting and/or reconditioning.

≡ Sl. No. 18 — Repair and maintenance for official or functional use

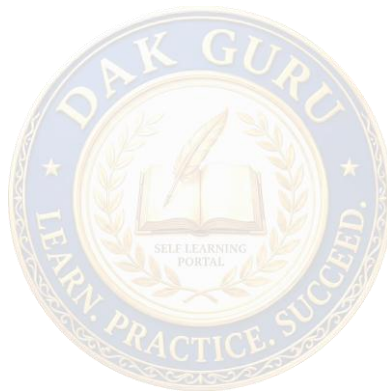
Covers: (i) Office equipment including computers; (ii) Digital equipment for office use; (iii) Furniture & Fixtures; (iv) Tools & Plants; (v) Vehicles (including motor vehicles and non-motor vehicles like bicycles, rickshaws, carts, trolleys and boats, etc.).

✂ *AMENDED by Addendum III — Rs. 10,000 → Rs. 25,000/- in each case*

Extent of Powers	Up to Rs. 25,000/- in each case
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Rules / Restrictions

Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.



Other Financial Powers of Divisional Heads

► Sl. No. 14 — Refunds

(a) Refund of Earnest Money received from tenderers

In respect of contracts within the competency of the Divisional Head.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers (in respect of tenders within the competency of Divisional Head)
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(b) Refund of Air Surcharge / Difference between Air-mail Fee-cum-Postage & Surface Postage

In case of surcharged airmail articles subjected to delay beyond the ordinary delivery time, consequent on such articles being sent by surface route due to fault of service.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(c) Refund of Postage on Articles Maliciously Sent Unpaid

Sent unpaid for the purpose of annoying the addressee.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(d) Refund of Coins, Currency Notes, Unused Postage Stamps, Postcards, Embossed Envelopes / Stamp Booklets found in Letter Boxes / PO Counters

Provided value has been credited in the accounts of the office.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(e) Refund of Amounts Overpaid by / Short-Paid to a Member of Public

And found in excess in the accounts of an office.

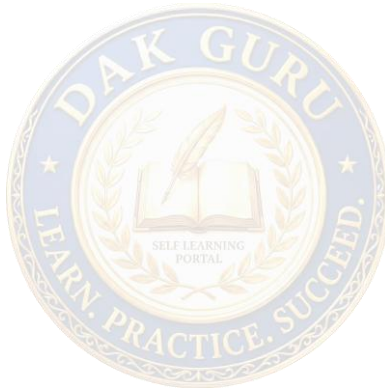
Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to nodal dept / DoP rules.

(f) Compensation of Loss or Damage or Non-Delivery

+ NEW refund head inserted by Addendum III – w.e.f. 09.06.2026

As specified by administrative instructions.

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.



Financial Powers of Heads of Foreign Post Office

+ NEW category inserted by Addendum III – w.e.f. 09.06.2026

Per Note 3 of the Schedule, the In-charge of Foreign Post exercises delegated financial powers equivalent to HoD / Independent Director / Divisional Head, as the case may be. Addendum III sets out the following refund powers for Heads of Foreign Post Office.

► Sl. No. 19 — Refunds

Extent of Powers	Full Powers
Rules / Restrictions	Subject to any rules / instructions issued by any Nodal Department / DoP.

Refund heads under Sl. No. 19

- (a) Refund of air surcharge or the difference between the air-mail fee-cum-postage, in case of surcharged air-mail articles which are subjected to delay beyond the time ordinarily taken for the delivery thereof consequent on such articles being sent by the surface route due to fault of service.
- (b) Refund of postage on articles which have been maliciously sent unpaid for the purpose of annoying the addressee.
- (c) Compensation of loss or damage or non-delivery as specified by administrative instructions.

Master Comparison: HOC vs HOD vs Divisional Head

This chapter consolidates the most heavily-tested numerical limits side-by-side, updated as per Addendum II (08.09.2025). Amber-highlighted cells mark values changed by Addendum II.

Object Head 01 — Salaries

Ad-hoc Payment of Arrears of Pay & Allowances

Officer	Limit	Source
HOC	Rs. 1,00,000/- per case	Sch. II-A Sl. 1(ii)
HOD	Rs. 50,000/- per case	Sch. II-A Sl. 1(ii)
Divisional Head	Not applicable (refer HOD/HOC)	Sch. III does not delegate this item

Object Head 05 — Rewards

Item	HOC	HOD	Div. Head
Cash Award to Postal Employees	Rs. 25,000/-	Rs. 25,000/-	N/A
Cash Award to GDS (courage in protecting Govt. property)	Rs. 25,000/-	Rs. 25,000/-	N/A
Reward to non-Govt. informers (criminal cases)	Rs. 10,000/-	Rs. 10,000/-	N/A
Reward to non-Govt. informers (anticipatory work)	Rs. 10,000/-	Rs. 10,000/-	N/A

Object Head 09 — Training Expenses

Officer / Item	Domestic Training	Foreign Training
HOC / HOD	Rs. 2 Lakh per case	Full Powers (with prior approval of Secretary (Posts) / MoC / SCoS)
Director RAKNPA — outsourced services from training institutes	Up to Rs. 2 Crore per annum	—
Divisional Head	Not delegated	Not delegated

Object Head 13 — Office Expenses (Key Items)

Item	HOC	HOD	Divisional Head
Recurring Contingent (per case)	Rs. 5 L (cap 50 L p.a.)	Rs. 3 L (cap 30 L p.a.)	Not delegated (use NRC head)
Non-Recurring Contingent (per case)	Rs. 5 L (cap 50 L p.a.)	Rs. 3 L (cap 30 L p.a.)	Rs. 25,000/- (cap 3 L p.a.)
Electric / Gas / Water / Tel. / Internet / Cable	Full Powers	Full Powers	Full Powers
Petty Stationery (per annum)	Rs. 15 Lakh	Rs. 10 Lakh	Not specifically delegated
Hot & Cold Weather Charges (per case)	—	—	Rs. 10,000/-
Fixtures & Furniture	Full Powers (IFA >₹75,000)	Full Powers (IFA >₹75,000)	Rs. 1 L/case (cap 10 L p.a.)
Working Lunch	Full Powers	Full Powers	Not delegated
Auction Commission Charges	Rs. 2 Lakh	Rs. 1 Lakh	Not delegated
Outsourcing (Postal/RMS/MMS + Sec/HK) p.a.	₹20 Cr (7 circles) / ₹10 Cr	₹5 Crore	Not delegated
Foundation Stone / Inauguration (per occasion)	Rs. 10 Lakh	Rs. 10 Lakh	Not delegated
Hospitality (gifts, conf., seminars, study tours)	Full Powers (IFA >₹2 L)	Full Powers (IFA >₹2 L)	Not delegated
Funeral Expenses	Rs. 25,000/-	Rs. 25,000/-	Not delegated
Office Equipment within threshold	Full Powers (IFA >₹75,000)	Full Powers (IFA >₹75,000)	Rs. 50,000/- (cap 5 L p.a.)
Carriage of Mails by modes other than Rail/Air	Use OH-49 head	Use OH-49 head	₹50,000/case (cap 6 L p.a.)
Embedding chests / painting LBs / signboards	Use general heads	Use general heads	Rs. 10,000/- per case
Police escort for carriage of cash	—	—	Full Powers
Customer Meets	—	—	Rs. 25,000/- per meet

Object Head 14 — Rent, Rates & Taxes

Renting of Office Accommodation — by City Class

Officer	X-Class City	Y-Class City	Z-Class City
HOC	Rs. 10 Lakh/month	Rs. 10 Lakh/month	Rs. 10 Lakh/month
HOD	Rs. 2 Lakh/month	Rs. 1 Lakh/month	Rs. 50,000/month
Divisional Head (without FRAC)	Rs. 15,000/month	Rs. 12,000/month	Rs. 8,000/month

Hiring for Examinations / Events / Customer Meets

Officer	Limit
HOC / HOD	Full Powers
Divisional Head	Up to Rs. 10,000/- in each case

Object Head 16 — Printing & Publication

Item	HOC / HOD	Divisional Head
Through Directorate of Printing	Full Powers	Not delegated
Through Private Presses	Full Powers	Not delegated
Other Printing & Binding (general)	Rs. 5 Lakh p.a.	Rs. 2 Lakh p.a.
Publicity Material (rate charts / mailers / brochures)	Use OH-26 / OH-16	Rs. 20,000/- p.a.
Newspapers & Magazines / e-books / pen drives / CDs	Full Powers	Not delegated

New Object Heads / Items in Schedule III (Add-II & Add-III)

Object Head / Item (Schedule III)	Sl. No.	Divisional Head Limit
OH-06 Medical Treatment [Add-III]	3(a)	Up to Rs. 2 Lakh each case
OH-19 Digital Equipment	15	Upto Rs. 20,000/- each case
OH-24 Fuels & Lubricants	16	Full Powers
OH-26 Advertising & Publicity	17	Upto Rs. 20,000/- each case
OH-29 Repair & Maintenance [Add-III: Rs. 25,000]	18	Upto Rs. 25,000/- each case
OH-13 Sl.8(xi) Police escort for cash	8(xi)	Full Powers

Note: In Schedule II-A, Repair & Maintenance is Object Head 35; in Schedule III (per Addendum II) it is labelled Object Head 29. Both cover the same category of expenditure.

Object Head 27 — Minor Civil & Electrical Works

Item	HOC / HOD	Divisional Head
Government Buildings (each case)	Rs. 10 Lakh	Rs. 1 Lakh (cap 5 L p.a.)
Rented Building (each case)	Rs. 5 Lakh	Rs. 30,000 (non-scheme) / Rs. 50,000 (scheme)
Removable Fittings — Rented Bldg (each case)	Rs. 5 Lakh	Rs. 30,000 (cap 3 L p.a.)
Dismantling of Building (HOC only)	Up to Rs. 50 Lakh	Not delegated
ROM — Diesel Gensets etc.	Full Powers	Not delegated

Object Head 28 — Professional Services

Item	HOC	HOD	Divisional Head
Engagement of Professionals (CA/Artists/GST) p.a.	Rs. 1 Crore	Rs. 20 Lakh	Not delegated
Market survey / consultants (CGM BD/PD/PLI & HOC)	Rs. 50 Lakh/case	—	Not delegated
Law Officers/Counsels/Advocates/Arbitrators	Full Powers (IFA > ₹2 L)	Full Powers (IFA > ₹2 L)	—
Other Legal Charges (law suits, prosecution)	Full Powers	Full Powers	Not delegated

Item	HOC	HOD	Divisional Head
Legal Charges & copies of judgements	—	—	Up to Rs. 2 Lakh per case



Capital Powers (HOC/HOD) — Schedule II-A only

These capital powers are NOT delegated to Divisional Heads — all such procurement is escalated to HOC/HOD.

Object Head	Item	Limit (HOC / HOD)
51 — Motor Vehicles	New operational vehicle against condemnation [HOC]	Full Powers
51 — Motor Vehicles	New operational vehicle against condemnation [HOC & Dir. RAKNPA]	Full Powers
51 — Motor Vehicles	New Inspection Vehicle against condemnation [HOC]	Full Powers
52 — Machinery & Equip.	Fire Protection Appliances	Full Powers
52 — Machinery & Equip.	Other machinery & equipment (IFA >₹2 L)	Full Powers
71 — ICT Equipment	Desktop Computers & peripherals (non-scheme)	Rs. 5 Lakh each case
71 — ICT Equipment	Replacement Desktops & peripherals (non-scheme)	Up to Rs. 20 Lakh each case
71 — ICT Equipment	Desktops under SCHEMES [HOC]	Full Powers
71 — ICT Equipment	Laptops for eligible officers [HOC]	₹1,00,000 + tax (MII >40%: ₹1,30,000 + tax)
71 — ICT Equipment	Laptops for office use only	HOC Rs. 50 L p.a.; HOD Rs. 25 L p.a.
72 — Buildings	Construction / Reconstruction	HOC Rs. 20 Cr; HOD Rs. 10 Cr
72 — Buildings	Addition/Alteration — Non-Res. (each case)	HOC&HOD Rs. 5 Cr; heritage Rs. 20 Cr (HOC)
72 — Buildings	Addition/Alteration — Res. (each case)	Up to Rs. 2 Crores (excl. overheads)
72 — Buildings	Procurement of Infrastructural Assets (each case)	Rs. 2 Crores
74 — Furniture & Fixtures	Furniture above threshold (IFA >₹2 L)	Full Powers
76 — Heritage Assets [HOC]	Upgradation / heritage / n.e.c.	As per limit fixed by Nodal Dept / DoP
77 — Other Fixed Assets	Battery / Electric cart for mail conveyance	Full Powers

Object Head	Item	Limit (HOC / HOD)
77 – Other Fixed Assets	Library books, trees, crops & plants	Full Powers



Conveyance of Mails — HOC / HOD Powers

Mode	Limit	IFA
By Rail	Full Powers	Beyond ₹2 L per case
By Air	Full Powers	Beyond ₹2 L per case
By Road incl. RTN per contract	HOC Rs. 20 Cr; HOD Rs. 1 Cr	Beyond ₹2 L per case
By Other Means (emergency, no tender)	Rs. 5 Lakh/month/route	Required
By Other Means (emergency, up to 3 months)	Rs. 5 Lakh/month/case	Required
To Foreign Countries by non-contract steamer	Rs. 10 Lakhs	Required
All other charges	Full Powers	Beyond ₹2 L
Diversion (breaches, floods, accidents)	Full Powers	Beyond ₹2 L

Write-Off & Condemnation — HOC ONLY

Item	Limit
Write-off — Loss of Revenue (each case)	Rs. 5,000/-
Write-off — Irrecoverable losses of Stores / Public Money (each case)	Rs. 50,000/-
Write-off — Deficiencies / Depreciation in stores (each case)	Rs. 50,000/-
Mature Condemnation of Motor Vehicle / Motorcycle	Full Powers
Condemnation of Vehicles aged 15 years (via RVSF)	Full Powers

Refunds — Cross-Schedule Comparison

Refund Item	HOC	HOD	Div. Head
Earnest Money	Full Powers	Full Powers	Full (within DH competency)
Postage Charges (incl. franking)	Full (sub-limits)	Full (sub-limits)	Not directly delegated
Fee for Duplicate SB Passbook	Full Powers	Full Powers	Not directly delegated

Refund Item	HOC	HOD	Div. Head
Mis-delivered Uninsured Postal Article	Full Powers	Full Powers	Not directly delegated
Advertisement Charges per case	Rs. 50,000/-	Rs. 10,000/-	Not delegated
Air Surcharge / Air-mail Fee difference	Full Powers	Full Powers	Full Powers
Postage on Articles Maliciously Sent Unpaid	Full Powers	Full Powers	Full Powers
Coins / Notes / Stamps in Letter Boxes	Full Powers	Full Powers	Full Powers
Amounts overpaid / short-paid (excess in accounts)	Full Powers	Full Powers	Full Powers



Quick-Revision Mnemonics & Memory Hooks

◆ MAGIC NUMBER: ₹2,00,000 (Two Lakh) — The IFA Trigger

Across MOST Schedule II-A items, IFA consultation is REQUIRED beyond Rs. 2,00,000/- per case.

Notable variations — where the IFA threshold DIFFERS:

- Sl. 1(iv) Honorarium / Rewards → IFA beyond Rs. 2,500/-
- Sl. 4(a) Medical Reimbursement (OH-06) → IFA beyond Rs. 1,00,000/- [NEW]
- Sl. 10(i) & 10(ii) Contingent (recurring / non-recurring) → IFA beyond Rs. 1,00,000/-
- Sl. 10(v) Fixtures & furniture → IFA beyond Rs. 75,000/-
- Sl. 10(ix) Office equipment → IFA beyond Rs. 75,000/-
- Sl. 12(i)(c) Printing 'Others' → IFA beyond Rs. 50,000/-
- Sl. 13(iii) Hiring vehicle emergent → IFA beyond Rs. 50,000/-
- Sl. 24(i) Freight → IFA NOT required
- Sl. 33(i) Permanent Advance → IFA required (no threshold)

◆ MAGIC NUMBER: ₹1,00,000 / 3 Years — Capital vs Revenue Threshold

Threshold for classifying capital vs revenue expenditure:

→ Rs. 1 LAKH cost OR 3 YEARS of useful life — EITHER OF THE TWO.

Below threshold → REVENUE (Office Expenses-13, Digital Equipment-19, F&F-13)

Above threshold → CAPITAL (Machinery-52, ICT-71, Furniture-74)

Exception → Motor Vehicles (OH-51) — ALWAYS capital irrespective of usage / cost.

◆ Other Key Numbers

5 YEARS — max lease of hired accommodation; possession certainty for rented-building works.

6 YEARS — HOC may authorise investigation of arrears records more than 6 years old.

15 YEARS — HOC may scrap vehicles reaching 15 years via RVSF (MoRTH).

3 MONTHS — refund claim window for franking machine impressions.

8% — rent ceiling vs capital cost of building (project areas).

5% — permissible variation in plinth area.

6¼% — reduction on unused spoilt postage stamps refund; 20% on postal stationery; 5% franking error.

City-Class Cheat Sheet — for OH-14 Rent

◆ Pattern by Officer

HOC = Rs. 10 Lakh/month for ALL classes (flat)

HOD: X = Rs. 2 L, Y = Rs. 1 L, Z = Rs. 50,000

HOD residential & other purposes: X = Rs. 30 K, Y = Rs. 20 K, Z = Rs. 15 K

Divisional Head (office, without FRAC): X = Rs. 15 K, Y = Rs. 12 K, Z = Rs. 8 K

DH mnemonic: "Fifteen, Twelve, Eight" (₹'000/month).

The 7 'Premium' Circles for Outsourcing

◆ Rs. 20 Crore p.a. circles — Memory Hook: DK-MTT-UW

D — Delhi

K — Karnataka

M — Maharashtra

T — Tamil Nadu

T — Telangana

U — Uttar Pradesh (UP)

W — West Bengal

All OTHER circles → Rs. 10 Crore per annum (HOC).

HOD (any circle) → Rs. 5 Crore per annum. [ADDED by Addendum II]

"HOC ONLY" — Exclusive Power Categories (post Addendum III)

◆ Items still reserved exclusively for HOC under Schedule II-A

1. Purchases for PSD & Stores for works [Sl.15(i),(ii)]
2. Indents from Govt. Press / Stationery / Undertakings [Sl.15(iv)]
3. Dismantling of Building [Sl.18(iv)]
4. Awards & Prizes [Sl.22 = OH 40]
5. Other Revenue Expenditure — residuary [Sl.24(vii)]
6. Inspection Vehicle against condemnation [Sl.25(ii)]
7. Heritage Assets — upgradation [Sl.31 = OH 76]
8. All Write-offs & Vehicle Condemnation [Sl.34(i)–(v)]

Watch out — items NO LONGER HOC-only after Addendum III:

- Outsourcing [10(xi)(a)] → HOD now gets ₹5 Cr p.a.
- Operational Vehicle [25(i)] → HOC & Director (RAKNPA)
- Office laptops [27(v)] → HOC ₹50 L & HOD ₹25 L p.a.
- Construction/reconstruction [28(i)] → HOC ₹20 Cr & HOD ₹10 Cr

- Conveyance by Road/RTN [35(iii)] → HOC ₹20 Cr & HOD ₹1 Cr
- Negotiated/Single tender [37] → HOC ₹50 L & HOD ₹10 L
- Rewards to GDS / informers [4(ii)–(iv)] are stated generally in Add-III (no HOC-only tag).



Final Exam Capsule — Most Likely MCQ Numbers (latest, Add-III)

Item	Key Number
DFPR 2024 effective date	01.04.2024
Revised DoP Schedules notified	28.03.2025 (effective 01.04.2025)
Addendum I / II / III dates	22.05.2025 / 08.09.2025 / 09.06.2026
DoP & DoT bifurcation	January, 1985
DoP under DFPR, 1978 w.e.f.	01.04.1988
Authority for delegation (DFPR 2024)	Rule 12(2)
HOD responsibility for authorised Gazetted officers	Rule 12(3)
Permanent Advance — based on	Avg. monthly contingent of preceding 12 months
IFA Trigger — default	Rs. 2,00,000/- per case
Capital vs Revenue threshold	Rs. 1 Lakh OR 3 years useful life
Lease ceiling for accommodation	5 years at a time
Refund claim window — franking	3 months
Arrears records investigation (HOC)	> 6 years old
Vehicle scrapping age via RVSF	15 years
Variation allowed in plinth area	5%
Rent ceiling vs project capital cost	8% of capital cost
Refund reduction — spoilt postage stamps / stationery	6¼% / 20% (franking error 5%)
Ad-hoc arrears of pay — headline extent	Up to Rs. 5,00,000/-
Cash Award Postal Employees / GDS	Rs. 25,000 / Rs. 25,000
Rewards to non-Govt persons (criminal / anticipatory)	Rs. 10,000 each
NEW — Medical Reimbursement (OH-06): HOC/HOD // DH	Rs. 10 Lakh // Rs. 2 Lakh per case
Recurring / Non-recurring contingent — HOC // HOD	Rs. 5 L (cap 50 L) // Rs. 3 L (cap 30 L)
Petty stationery — HOC / HOD / Secretary(PSB)	Rs. 15 L / Rs. 10 L / Rs. 10 L(cap 40 L) p.a.
Auction commission — HOC / HOD	Rs. 2 L / Rs. 1 L on any occasion
Foundation Stone / Inauguration (per occasion)	Rs. 10 Lakh
Printing 'Others' (per annum)	Rs. 5 Lakh
Advertising — BoC/DAVP // other media (per case)	Rs. 10 Lakh // Rs. 5 Lakh

Item	Key Number
Office laptops – HOC / HOD (p.a.)	Rs. 50 Lakh / Rs. 25 Lakh
Construction / Reconstruction – HOC / HOD	Rs. 20 Cr / Rs. 10 Cr
Addition/Alteration non-res – HOC&HOD // heritage(HOC)	Rs. 5 Cr // Rs. 20 Cr each case
Outsourcing – 7 Circles / others / HOD / DEO-MTS(Secy)	20 Cr / 10 Cr / 5 Cr / 1 Cr p.a.
Conveyance By Road / RTN – HOC / HOD per contract	Rs. 20 Cr / Rs. 1 Cr
Conveyance by other means / foreign steamer	Rs. 5 L per month / Rs. 10 Lakhs
Negotiated / Single Tender – HOC / HOD	Rs. 50 Lakh / Rs. 10 Lakh
Procurement of Infrastructural Assets	Rs. 2 Crores each case
IPO 2nd commission waiver value limit	Rs. 1,000/- per case
DH contingent (non-recurring) / office equipment	Rs. 25,000 / Rs. 50,000 per case
DH customer meets / carriage of mails	Rs. 25,000 / Rs. 50,000 per case
DH Minor Civil – Govt / Rented(non-sch) / Rented(sch)	Rs. 1 L / Rs. 30,000 / Rs. 50,000
DH Repair & Maintenance (OH-29)	Rs. 25,000/- each case
DH Digital Equip / Advertising (OH-19 / OH-26)	Rs. 20,000/- each case
DH Fuels & Lubricants / Police escort for cash	Full Powers
NEW – Director Postal Services (HQ) added to	the Head of Department (HOD) definition

~ End of Study Notes ~

Updated as per Addendum III dated 09.06.2026.

Wishing you success in the LDCE IP / PS Gr. B Examination!

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